

AI TOOL STACK

AI Business Launch Kit 2026

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AI Business Launch Kit 2026 - File 06

A practical directory of AI and no-code tools by category. This kit is intentionally tool-agnostic - the prompts, worksheets, and systems in Files 02-05 work regardless of which specific tools you choose, and will keep working even after individual tools change.

Important: AI tools, their pricing, and their feature sets change frequently. Every "Free/Paid Status" note below is a general description of how the tool is typically positioned (e.g., "has a free tier") - **verify current pricing and features directly on the tool's website before signing up or budgeting for it.** Nothing here should be treated as a locked-in price.

This is not a paid endorsement list. Use whichever tool in each category fits your budget and comfort level - most categories have a free or low-cost starting option.

AI Assistants (general-purpose)

Tool	Purpose	Best Use	Beginner Difficulty	Free/Paid Status	Suggested Workflow
ChatGPT	Conversational AI for writing, brainstorming, coding help	Alternative to Claude; good for quick brainstorming	Easy	Free tier + paid plans (verify current pricing/features)	Use interchangeably with Claude for Prompt Vault prompts
Perplexity	AI search assistant with cited sources	Market/trend research where you want source links	Easy	Free tier + paid plans (verify current pricing/features)	Use for Module 1 market research before finalizing an idea

Research

Tool	Purpose	Best Use	Beginner Difficulty	Free/Paid Status	Suggested Workflow
Google Trends	Search interest over time	Sanity-checking demand direction, not exact volume	Easy	Free	Use for a directional read, not a precise number
Reddit / niche forums	Real, unfiltered customer language	Sourcing pain-point quotes (Module 2)	Easy	Free	Search your niche + "problem," "frustrated," "how do I"

Writing

Tool	Purpose	Best Use	Beginner Difficulty	Free/Paid Status	Suggested Workflow
Grammarly	Grammar and clarity checking	Final proofread pass before publishing	Easy	Free tier + paid plans (verify current pricing/features)	Run any AI draft through it before sending/posting
Hemingway Editor	Readability scoring	Simplifying dense copy for beginners	Easy	Free (web version)	Use after P082 (Content Simplification Prompt)

Design

Tool	Purpose	Best Use	Beginner Difficulty	Free/Paid Status	Suggested Workflow
Figma	Design and prototyping tool	Custom layouts, landing page mockups	Intermediate	Free tier + paid plans (verify current pricing/features)	Use once you outgrow templates

Image Generation

Tool	Purpose	Best Use	Beginner Difficulty	Free/Paid Status	Suggested Workflow
Canva's built-in AI image tools	In-app AI image generation	Quick visuals without leaving your design tool	Easy	Included in Canva plans (verify current pricing/features)	Fastest option if you're already using Canva

Video

Tool	Purpose	Best Use	Beginner Difficulty	Free/Paid Status	Suggested Workflow
Descript	Text-based video/audio editing	Editing by editing the transcript	Intermediate	Free tier + paid plans (verify current pricing/features)	Good for podcast/long-form video editing

Audio

Tool	Purpose	Best Use	Beginner Difficulty	Free/Paid Status	Suggested Workflow
Descript	Transcription + audio cleanup	Podcast editing, noise removal	Intermediate	Free tier + paid plans (verify current pricing/features)	Use for the podcast show-notes idea (Module 1, #4)

Website Building

Tool	Purpose	Best Use	Beginner Difficulty	Free/Paid Status	Suggested Workflow
Webflow / Framer	Full website builders with AI-assisted design	A complete business website	Intermediate	Free tier + paid plans (verify current pricing/features)	Use once you're ready to build beyond a single page
Wix / Squarespace	All-in-one website builders	Full site with built-in e-commerce/booking	Easy-Intermediate	Free trial + paid plans (verify current pricing/features)	Good all-in-one option for service businesses

Automation

Tool	Purpose	Best Use	Beginner Difficulty	Free/Paid Status	Suggested Workflow
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Make (formerly Integromat)	Visual no-code automation builder	More complex, multi-step workflows	Intermediate-Advanced	Free tier + paid plans (verify current pricing/features)	Use once your automations need more branching logic
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Email

Tool	Purpose	Best Use	Beginner Difficulty	Free/Paid Status	Suggested Workflow
Mailchimp	Email marketing platform	Broadcasts and basic automation	Easy	Free tier + paid plans (verify current pricing/features)	Alternative to ConvertKit for smaller lists

Social Media

Tool	Purpose	Best Use	Beginner Difficulty	Free/Paid Status	Suggested Workflow
Canva Content Planner	Scheduling built into Canva	Design and schedule in one place	Easy	Included in Canva plans (verify current pricing/features)	Good if you're already designing in Canva

Productivity

Tool	Purpose	Best Use	Beginner Difficulty	Free/Paid Status	Suggested Workflow
Google Workspace	Docs, Sheets, Calendar, Gmail	General business operations	Easy	Free tier + paid plans (verify current pricing/features)	Use Sheets for File 09's dashboard if you prefer Google
Airtable	Spreadsheet-database hybrid	Lead tracking, content calendar, CRM-lite	Intermediate	Free tier + paid plans (verify current pricing/features)	Use for lead tracking (Workflow 1, Module 9)

Analytics

Tool	Purpose	Best Use	Beginner Difficulty	Free/Paid Status	Suggested Workflow
Native platform analytics (Instagram/LinkedIn/YouTube Insights)	Content performance data	Reviewing what content resonates	Easy	Free (built into each platform)	Use weekly with P146 (Content Performance Review)

How To Choose Your Starting Stack

You do not need every tool in this list. For your first 30 days, this is realistically enough:

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[ ] One AI assistant (Claude or ChatGPT)
[ ] One design tool (Canva)
[ ] One landing page tool (Carrd, or your website builder)
[ ] One email tool (ConvertKit or Mailchimp)
[ ] One scheduling tool (Buffer or Later) - optional if posting manually
[ ] One spreadsheet (Google Sheets, or the File 09 dashboard)
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Add automation, video, and audio tools only once your manual process is proven and repetitive enough to be worth automating.